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Specialized Bicycle Components - Marketing Admin

This summer, I had the opportunity to work alongside a few amazing coworkers at Specialized Bicycle Components, located in Morgan Hill. My specific role was Marketing Admin, where my duties were aligned with serving as an assistant to the Marketing Manager of the water bottle department at Specialized. Throughout this opportunity, I gained hands-on experience that furthered my learning, moving from the classroom to real-world experiences.

Within this internship, one can say it may not be fully considered an internship as it was a contract position, which I will be happily able to continue throughout my education this upcoming school year. While being a marketing admin, I have been working 22 hours a week, where I assist in marketing campaigns, product launches, tradeshow activations, as well as day-to-day duties of being in marketing. This opportunity allowed me to wear many hats by playing roles in different marketing positions, including digital, product, and campaign marketing. Throughout this internship, I learned how to successfully launch a campaign through the use of social media assets, the USA newsletter, and the B2B newsletters. Some other new things I learned were the process of going through logo development, as well as the legal requirements that are behind it. This is one thing that I never had really thought about before this job opportunity, and it is one that truly opened my eyes to see the heart and soul that goes behind picking a logo that truly represents the brand that you are trying to convey. Other things that I learned were how to properly communicate with others within the business. Throughout my

position, there were many emails that I had to send regarding updates within certain product stock, as well as reaching out to individuals to meet with them if I had any questions. This really opened my eyes to how to effectively communicate with those whom I may not know and how I can bridge the gap to create effective communication. The most important thing that I feel I learned was through a monthly meeting that I would have with some of our advertising analysts. The two women that we would meet with would go over our KPIs to see how we were tracking and how we were performing. I've learned in class what cost per click is, as well as many other performance metrics, but I had never been able to actively use them within a real-world scenario. This allowed me to truly connect what I was learning and see it in the real world, and how it would play out, and what it effectively means when we're trying to promote something. This is one thing that I will take away from this job more than I will take away from anything else, because it truly allowed me to see that what I was creating was influencing those that we are trying to connect with.

Within this role, it truly surprised me how much it goes into email marketing specifically. Email marketing is something that is very different throughout multiple companies, and it is something that equally represents a company as well as what they are trying to inform other people about. At specialized, I would send an email to a B2B group who would then send it out worldwide to roughly 30,000 customers. This is something that truly surprised me because it was very eye-opening to send out an email to such a large group of people. While sending out these emails, it was also really insightful for me to see how many people opened them, as well as the bounce rate that we would get. This really surprised me because a lot of other emails that would go out were mainly just pictures, whereas we try to include some form of informational text. Although this may not be the best route taken, we are still learning what is important and what is

actively working for us. For example, the last email we sent out, we did notice that a lot of our competitors weren't using text within their email, allowing us to reconfigure the way we are structuring our emails and how not including text could potentially allow for more audience interaction.

When reflecting on this position, I will use the learnings from this job for future experiences in many ways. I believe that when it comes to future interview opportunities, I will be able to support many of my experiences with numbers and actual data behind them. In my previous interviews, I didn't feel that I could give a structured answer on my background and specific real-world experience that actually mattered. Moving forward, I definitely can see myself answering some of these difficult questions with real-world experience and actual backgrounds in a job position rather than focusing on experiences I've had in group projects or in a school environment. I also feel that from this position, I have further learned how to speak to people and the correct terminology to use when referring to specific analytics or other types of content. I feel that this will give me a really good basis when it comes to answering interview questions, as well as really demonstrating myself as a mature and independent individual who can answer questions in an appropriate manner. This allows me to have a sense of background and foundation to my answers, rather than trying to really dig in my brain and come up with examples from previous job opportunities. Again, a lot of the past jobs that I have had that I use as examples are not jobs that are in the field that I would like to go into, whereas the job that I had this summer allows me to connect to a specific field. Being able to work over the summer, I believe, truly gave me a deeper understanding of what it's like to work in a corporate position and allowed me to understand the ways of working in this type of environment.

Connecting to the EMPAC analysis model, I was able to learn more about price and promotions, mainly on how to time promotions appropriately throughout the year. I was able to learn how to space campaigns in a manner that doesn't reflect poorly on the company but allows people to stay actively engaged with the product and future purchases. For example, one thing we are working on is our Black Friday sale, which is obviously a holiday promotion that a lot of companies do as well. I'd say the one other thing that I learned was probably product assortment, as Specialized has a few different types of water bottles depending on their size and function. This allows us to compete with other water bottle companies, as Specialized Custom offers the opportunity where people can design their own water bottles, as well as pick a shape that they feel best fits their needs. It was difficult to connect to other analysis opportunities, including in-store as well as Direct competitors, because our products were mainly going to businesses rather than individual consumers. To further understand this, many of our water bottles have a minimum purchase quantity of about a hundred. This allows companies to bulk purchase water bottles, which they then give out and can sell on their own. In summary, the main analysis from the EMPAC model that I was able to connect to was probably the price and promotions, as it allowed me to again see how timing is really important when it comes to campaigns.

In conclusion, I am extremely grateful that I was offered this role at specialized bicycle components, and I am extremely excited to continue my position throughout the school year. I think that this will help further my knowledge as well as really connect it to what I'm learning in my classes. One thing I'm looking forward to this upcoming school year, in connection to this job, is any group projects that I may have where I can really connect my hands-on learning to that project to gain a deeper insight, as well as truly understand the meaning behind it.